

Question ID: 77e3b3b3

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Rhetorical Synthesis	Medium

Question

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- 2024: Spain and Portugal sponsored a workshop to address recent encounters between Iberian orcas and marine vessels off the Iberian Peninsula.
- Many of the 637 documented incidents involved pods of orcas damaging vessels by ramming, nudging, or biting the rudders.
- Studies of Iberian orcas suggest recent increases in tuna populations have reduced the time the orcas spend hunting by 99%.
- Researchers believe this shift has increased the number of interactions between marine vessels and understimulated orcas.
- The workshop advised mariners to avoid orcas pending further testing of the efficacy of TAST, a harmless acoustic deterrent.

The student wants to make and support a claim about Iberian orca behavior. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

Answer

- A. The recent destructive behavior of Iberian orcas may be the result of understimulation, given that orcas’ interactions with marine vessels have increased as the orcas have spent less time hunting.
- B. As supported by the workshop’s analysis of 637 encounters between vessels and Iberian orcas, TAST is a harmless and effective acoustic deterrent.
- C. In 2024, Spain and Portugal sponsored a workshop that addressed incidents where pods of Iberian orcas were ramming, nudging, or biting the rudders of vessels.
- D. Tuna populations have increased by approximately 99% off the Iberian Peninsula due to changes in the hunting behavior of Iberian orcas.

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence makes and supports a claim about Iberian orca behavior, claiming that the orcas’ destructive behavior may be the result of understimulation and citing as support the fact that as orcas have spent less time hunting (a stimulating activity), encounters with vessels have increased.

Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence makes a claim about an orca deterrent, it misrepresents information from the notes. The workshop advised avoiding orcas pending further testing of TAST’s efficacy; it didn’t claim that TAST was effective. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence describes a workshop that addressed the orcas’ behavior; it doesn’t make or support a claim about their behavior. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence does make a claim about orcas’ hunting behavior, it misrepresents information from the notes; the notes state that increased tuna populations have reduced orcas’ hunting time by 99%, not that tuna populations have increased by 99% because of the orcas’ behavior.